A good definition of an investing genius is the man or woman who can do the average thing when all those around them are going crazy.

Tails drive everything.

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When you accept that tails drive everything in business, investing, and finance you realize that it's normal for lots of things to go wrong, break, fail, and fall.

If you're a good stock picker you'll be right maybe half the time.

If you're a good business leader maybe half of your product and strategy ideas will work.

If you're a good investor most years will be just OK, and plenty will be bad.

If you're a good worker you'll find the right company in the right field after several attempts and trials.

And that's if you're good.

Peter Lynch is one of the best investors of our time. "If you're terrific in this business, you're right six times out of 10," he once said.

There are fields where you must be perfect every time. Flying a plane, for example. Then there are fields where you want to be at least pretty good nearly all the time. A restaurant chef, let's say.

Investing, business, and finance are just not like these fields.

Something I've learned from both investors and entrepreneurs is that no one makes good decisions all the time. The most impressive people are packed full of horrendous ideas that are often acted upon.

Take Amazon. It's not intuitive to think a failed product launch at a major company would be normal and fine. Intuitively, you'd think the CEO should apologize to shareholders. But CEO Jeff Bezos said shortly after the disastrous launch of the company's Fire Phone:

> If you think that's a big failure, we're working on much bigger failures right now. I am not kidding. Some of them are going to make the Fire Phone look like a tiny little blip.